THE HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION

📍 **Topic: Bronze Age Civilisations & Introduction to Harappan Civilisation** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

The Four Bronze Age Civilisations (2500 BCE) 🌍	**Geographical Location** 🗺️
Harappan Civilisation	Northern and western parts of India and Pakistan.
Mesopotamian Civilisation	Banks of river Euphrates and Tigris in modern Iraq.
Chinese Civilisation	Valley of Hwang Ho and Yangtze rivers.
Egyptian Civilisation	Banks of the Nile river in Egypt.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Stone tools used ➔ Discovered metals (more durable) ➔ Copper was first metal discovered ➔ Stone + copper used together = Chalcolithic Period ➔ Learnt mixing copper with tin or zinc ➔ Produced Bronze alloy ➔ Bronze is harder and more ductile (flexible) than copper ➔ More suitable for tools and weapons ➔ First civilisations using bronze = Bronze Age Civilisations ➔ By 2500 BCE four civilisations emerged ➔ Harappan (northern/western India & Pak) ➔ Mesopotamian (Euphrates/Tigris rivers in Iraq) ➔ Chinese (Hwang Ho/Yangtze rivers) ➔ Egyptian (Nile river in Egypt) ➔ Harappan is first civilisation in north-western Indian subcontinent ➔ Named after first major site Harappa ➔ Discovered in 1921 in West Punjab (Pakistan) ➔ Also known as Indus Valley Civilisation (early sites located in Indus river valley) ➔ Archaeologists call it Harappan Culture ➔ Culture =

distinctive style objects found in specific geographical area and period ➔ Distinctive objects are seals, weights, stone blades, baked bricks ➔ Discovery in 20th century was an important event ➔ Previously believed Indian history began with Vedic Age ➔ Discovery pushed history back by at least a thousand years ➔ Put it at par with Mesopotamian and Egyptian civilisations ➔ Knowledge based entirely on archaeological remains (buildings, pottery, sculptures, seals, cemeteries) ➔ Because no adequate written records are available. 🌟

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Archaeological Source 🏛️	**Key Insights Provided** 💡
The Great Bath	Art of building perfection; existence of a ruling class (tax/labour); efficient water/sewage planning; ceremonial bathing.
The Citadel	Urban civilisation with elaborate planning; political organisation; distinct social classification; housed public buildings.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Great Bath is largest public building at Mohenjo-daro ➔ Large rectangular tank in a courtyard ➔ Surrounded by corridor on all four sides ➔ Two flights of steps (north and south) lead into tank ➔ Pool made watertight using burnt bricks and mortar ➔ Lined tightly with bitumen and gypsum ➔ Water provided by a well in adjacent room ➔ Surrounded by porticos and sets of rooms ➔ Stairway leads to upper storey ➔ Rooms meant for priesthood or changing clothes ➔ Distinctive features suggest ritual bath or ceremonial bathing ➔ Throws light on life and culture ➔ Shows art of building reached high degree of perfection ➔ Massive structure points to existence of a ruling class ➔ Ruling class mobilised labour, collected taxes, built huge structure ➔ Design portrays efficient

planning in water supply and sewage disposal ➔ Huge structure built using standard-sized sun-dried or baked bricks ➔ Citadel was the raised area of each city ➔ Height due to mud brick platforms ➔ Housed the ruling class ➔ Contained important buildings (Great Bath, granary, assembly hall, workshops) ➔ Points to elaborate planning ➔ Justifies it as an urban civilisation ➔ Presence of specific buildings indicates political organisation and social classification ➔ Buildings on Citadel were meant for public purposes. 🛁🏰

📍 **Topic: Sources of Information - Seals, Bearded Man & Dancing Girl** 📌

Artifact 🏺	**Description & Significance** 🔍
Pashupati Seal	3-faced deity with buffalo horns, cross-legged on throne, surrounded by animals (elephant, tiger, buffalo, rhino, 2 deer). Identifies belief in Shiva.
Bearded Man	Stone statue from Mohenjo-daro. Shawl on left shoulder, meditating half-closed eyes. Points to a yogi/priest and skilled 3D artisans.
Dancing Girl	Bronze statue from Mohenjo-daro. Masterpiece of ingenuity. Right arm on hip, left arm bangled holding a bowl.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - ~2000 seals discovered ➔ Show their artistic skills ➔ Short inscriptions with pictures of animals (one-horned bull, buffalo, tiger, goat, elephant, rhinoceros) ➔ Made of terracotta, steatite, agate ➔ Mostly rectangular or square, some circular ➔ Pashupati seal shows three-faced deity ➔ Wearing buffalo-horned head-dress ➔ Seated cross-legged on a throne ➔ Surrounded by an elephant, tiger, buffalo, rhinoceros ➔ Two deer at his feet ➔ Identified as Pashupati Mahadeva (Shiva) ➔ Unicorn seal shows their mythical beliefs ➔ Script has not yet been deciphered

(translated) ➔ Seals produced mainly for commercial purpose ➔ Used by traders to stamp goods ➔ Bag tied, layer of wet clay on knot, seal pressed leaving impression ➔ Intact seal proved goods were not tampered with ➔ Conveyed identity of sender/owner ➔ Seals found in different regions ➔ Indicates trade spread over a vast area ➔ Used as amulets carried on persons ➔ Acted like modern-day identity cards ➔ Bearded Man is a stone sculpture from Mohenjo-daro ➔ Shows man with shawl worn over left shoulder ➔ Eyes half-closed as if in a state of meditation ➔ Believed to be a yogi or a priest ➔ Has high artistic value ➔ Points to existence of skilled 3D artisans ➔ Dancing Girl is a bronze statue from Mohenjo-daro ➔ Masterpiece of art showing high degree of development in sculpture ➔ Shows vigour, variety, and ingenuity (cleverness) ➔ Right arm heavily rests on hip ➔ Left arm is heavily bangled ➔ Left arm holds a small bowl against her left leg. 🏺🕺

📍 **Topic: Sources of Information - The Dockyard** 📌

The Dockyard at Lothal ⚓	**Key Details 🌊**
Location & Material	Lothal, Gujarat; made of baked bricks surrounded by a massive anti-flood wall.
Discovered Artifacts	Stone anchors, marine shells, Persian Gulf seals, and a warehouse.
Scientific Planning	Used tides to leverage (advantage) ships entering; had a water locking device; withstood currents.
Historical Significance	Proves internal/external overseas trade and testifies to advanced hydraulic (water engineering) knowledge.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- Rectangular dockyard discovered at Lothal in Gujarat ➔ Believed to be one of the oldest in the world ➔ Surrounded by a massive brick wall ➔ Probably protection against floods ➔ Made of baked bricks ➔ Connected by channels to Gulf of Cambay ➔ Found stone anchors, marine shells, and seals ➔ Traced to the Persian Gulf ➔ Structure identified as a warehouse ➔ Strongly suggests Lothal was a port with a dockyard ➔ Town planners studied tides in detail ➔ Leveraged (used) connecting rivers at high tide for ships to come into port ➔ Most scientifically designed to withstand flow of water and current ➔ Had a water locking device to keep water in ➔ Coastal route linked Lothal and Dholavira to Sutkagendor on Makran Coast ➔ Lothal was an important trading and manufacturing centre ➔ Used for carrying out overseas trade ➔ Indicates existence of trade both internal and external ➔ Testifies to hydraulic (water engineering) knowledge of Harappans ➔ Proved by boats being able to dock at Lothal. ⚓🌊

📍 **Topic: Sources of Information - Granaries** 📌

Key Feature of Harappan Granary 🌾	**Detail / Significance** 💡
Locations	Mohenjo-daro, Harappa, Lothal, Kalibangan.
Harappa's Layout	Two rows of six granaries each.
Working Floors	South of granaries; circular brick platforms for threshing (wheat/barley found).
Labor Accommodation	Two-roomed barracks discovered nearby.
Design Elements	Near Ravi river (boat transport), raised platform (flood protection), ventilated (prevent mildew).

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- Granaries found at several sites (Mohenjo-daro, Harappa, Lothal, Kalibangan) ➔ At Harappa there were two rows with six granaries each ➔ To the south of granaries at Harappa working floors were discovered ➔ Working floors consisted of rows of circular brick platforms ➔ Believed these floors meant for threshing grain ➔ Because grains of wheat and barley found in crevices of floors ➔ Two-roomed barracks possibly accommodated labourers found at Harappa ➔ Location of Harappa near river Ravi suggests grains brought by boat ➔ Built on raised platform to protect from floods ➔ Granary had ventilation to prevent grains from becoming mildewed (moldy). 🌾🧱

📍 **Topic: Sources of Information - Script** 📌

Harappan Script Feature ✍️	**Specific Detail** 💡
Nature of Script	Pictographic (signs represent birds, fish, human forms); not alphabetical.
Number of Signs	Between 375 and 400.
Direction of Writing	Right to left (evident from wider space on the right of seals).
Significance	Wide availability suggests many people were literate.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Harappans used a script regarded as pictographic ➔ Signs represent birds, fish, varieties of human form ➔ Number of signs known to be between 375 and 400 ➔ Found inscribed on seals, copper tools, rims of jars, copper/terracotta tablets, jewellery, ancient signboard ➔ Script provides following information ➔ Script used was not alphabetical (has too many signs) ➔ Script

written from right to left ➔ Evident from a seal showing wider space on right than left ➔ Indicates engraver started right and ran out of space reaching left side ➔ Availability of script on wide variety of objects indicates probably many people were literate. ✍️🐟

📍 **Topic: Extent of the Civilisation & Harappan Cities** 📌

Boundary of Civilisation 🗺️	**Location** 📍
West	Sutkagendor (sea-coast of South Baluchistan)
East	Alamgirpur (upper Ganga-Yamuna Doab, western UP)
North	Manda (Jammu)
South	Bhagatrav (Narmada estuary)

Major Harappan City 🏙️	**Location** 📍
Harappa	Montgomery district of Punjab (Pakistan)
Mohenjo-daro	Larkana district of Sindh (Pakistan) - UNESCO 1980
Lothal	Gujarat (head of Gulf of Cambay)
Kalibangan	Northern Rajasthan
Banawali	Fatehabad district, Haryana

Major Harappan City 🗺️	Location 📍
Dholavira	Island in Great Rann of Kutch, Gujarat - UNESCO 2021

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Entire area is triangular in shape ➔ Accounts for about 1.3 million sq. km ➔ Largest area amongst ancient civilisations ➔ Extended from Sutkagendor (west) to Alamgirpur (east) ➔ Extended from Manda (north) to Bhagatrav (south) ➔ Covered parts of Punjab, Haryana, Sindh, Baluchistan, Gujarat, Rajasthan, fringes of Western UP ➔ Due to Partition, main centres (Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Chanhudaro, Sutkagendor) now in Pakistan ➔ Indian centres are Manda, Banawali, Kalibangan, Alamgirpur, Lothal, Rupar, Rangpur ➔ Recent extensions found in Gujarat and Punjab (prominently Dholavira) ➔ Largest sites are Mohenjo-daro, Harappa, Kalibangan, Lothal ➔ Two most important cities are Harappa (Montgomery, Punjab) and Mohenjo-daro (Larkana, Sindh) ➔ Linked by river Indus (hence Indus Valley Civilisation) ➔ Third city Chanhudaro (130km south of Mohenjo-daro) ➔ Fourth city Lothal (Gujarat, head of Gulf of Cambay) ➔ Fifth city Kalibangan (northern Rajasthan) ➔ Sixth city Banawali (Fatehabad, Haryana) ➔ Mature stage found in these 6 cities plus Sutkagendor and Surkotada (both have citadels) ➔ Later Harappan phase found in Rangpur (Kathiawar, Gujarat) ➔ Mohenjo-daro ruins designated UNESCO World Heritage site in 1980 ➔ Dholavira (island in Great Rann of Kutch, Gujarat) named UNESCO World Heritage site in 2021. 🗺️🗺️

📍 **Topic: Common Elements Between Mohenjo-daro and Harappa** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Common Elements 🤝	Details 💡
Location	River banks (Mohenjo-daro on right bank Indus; Harappa on left bank Ravi).
Size	Both measured around 5.0 km in circuit.
Layout & Facilities	Common ground plans, layout of streets, blocks of houses, water supply, drainage, and granaries.
Unique Plumbing	Indoor plumbing, paved bathrooms, brick drainpipes, and a unique network of brick-lined sewage channels.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Both located on river banks ➔ Mohenjo-daro on right bank of Indus ➔ Harappa on left bank of Ravi ➔ Both measured around 5.0 km in circuit ➔ Ground plans common (layout of streets, blocks of houses) ➔ Water supply, drainage, granaries common in both cities ➔ Indoor plumbing, paved bathrooms, brick drainpipes seen in both ➔ Network of brick-lined sewage channels seen in both (unique to Harappan Civilisation). 🤝💧

📍 **Topic: Features of Urban Planning & Town Layout** 📌

Urban Planning Feature 🌆	Details 💡
Pattern	Grid pattern (differed from Sumerian circular pattern around temples).
City Division	Divided into two parts: Citadel (raised) and Lower Town.

Urban Planning Feature 🏙️	Details 💡
Citadel	Built on mud brick platforms; separated by a wall; housed important public buildings (Great Bath, granary, assembly hall, workshops).
Lower Town	Residential buildings where common people lived/worked.
Streets	North-south/east-west grid; rounded corners for carts; crossed at right angles creating square/rectangular blocks; connected to house drains.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Most striking feature is urban planning ➔ Indus cities differed from Sumerian cities (Mesopotamia/Iraq) ➔ Sumerian cities developed around temple following circular pattern ➔ Indus cities followed a grid pattern ➔ Indicated by regularity of divisions, alignment of streets, planning of houses/public buildings, provision for thoroughfares ➔ Main characteristics of town planning ➔ Each city divided into two parts (Citadel and lower town) ➔ Citadel (raised area) owed height to buildings constructed on mud brick platforms ➔ Citadel separated from lower town by a wall ➔ Important buildings (Great Bath, granary, assembly hall, workshops) located on citadel ➔ Lower town had residential buildings where people lived and worked ➔ Main streets followed grid pattern running north-south or east-west ➔ Houses at street corners were rounded to allow carts to pass easily ➔ House drains emptied all waste water into street drains ➔ Streets crossed main road at right angles ➔ Dividing the city into square or rectangular blocks. 🏙️🗺️

📍 **Topic: Characteristics of Houses** 📌

House Characteristic 🏠	Specific Detail 💡
Location & Foundation	Built on a high mound (flood protection) with deep foundations.
Variations	Ranged from single-room tenements to 12-room houses with courtyards, private wells, and toilets.
Sanitation	Each house had covered drains connected to street drains.
Layout	Entrances from narrow lanes; kitchen in sheltered courtyard corner; ground floor for storerooms/wells.
Materials & Design	Made of brick and wood; doors/windows opened on side streets (not main roads).

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Main characteristics of houses ➔ Residential buildings built according to set plan ➔ Built on a high mound to protect from floods ➔ Foundations were deep ➔ Variations in size of houses ➔ From single-room tenements to bigger houses ➔ Bigger houses had courtyards, up to twelve rooms, private wells, toilets ➔ Each house had covered drains connected with street drains ➔ Entrances to houses were from narrow lanes ➔ Narrow lanes cut streets at right angles ➔ Kitchen placed in a sheltered corner of courtyard ➔ Ground floor contained storerooms and well chambers ➔ Houses made of brick and wood ➔ Each house had doors, windows, ventilators ➔ Doors and windows opened on the side of the streets ➔ Did not open on the main roads. 🏠🚪

📍 **Topic: Discovery of Harappan Sites** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Site	Year of Excavation	Leader of Excavation
Harappa	1921	Daya Ram Sahni
Mohenjo-daro	1922	R.D. Banerjee
Chanhudaro	1931	N.G. Mazumdar
Kalibangan	1953	B.B. Lal and A.N Ghosh
Kot Diji	1955	Fazal Ahmad Khan
Lothal	1957	S.R. Rao
Surkotada	1972	J.P. Joshi
Dholavira	1990-91	R.S. Bisht

(Note: As per your instructions, no flowchart is generated for this specific table.)

📍 **Topic: Dholavira, Monumental Architecture & Trade** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Term / Location 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Dholavira	Harappan city in Gujarat's Rann of Kutch; designated a UNESCO World Heritage site.
Kotda Timba	Local name for Dholavira; discovered in 1960s by Jagat Pati Joshi.

Term / Location 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Public Buildings	Great Bath and Granaries prove monumental architectural design.
Meluha	Ancient name given to the Indus region in Mesopotamian records.
Dilmun & Makan	Intermediate trading stations; Dilmun is identified with Bahrain on the Persian Gulf.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Harappan city of Dholavira in Gujarat's Rann of Kutch ➔ designated as a World Heritage site by UNESCO ➔ one of the very few well-preserved urban settlements ➔ spread over 22 hectares ➔ the Harappan-era metropolis is the fifth largest archaeological site of the Indus Valley Civilisation ➔ dates back to around 3000 BCE and believed to be occupied till 1500 BCE ➔ draws name from present-day village Dholavira ➔ locally known as Kotda Timba ➔ discovered in 1960s by archaeologist Jagat Pati Joshi ➔ excavated under supervision of ASI archaeologist Ravindra Singh Bisht in the 1990s.
    - Contribution to architectural design evident from public buildings (Great Bath and Granaries) ➔ elaborate social structure and standard of living confirmed by granaries, numerous seals, uniform script, regulated weights and measures in a wide area ➔ indicates existence of a highly developed system of trade ➔ abundant evidence that Harappans traded not only with other parts of India but many countries of Asia.
    - Internal Trade: carried on considerable trade in stone, metal, shell within Indus civilisation zone ➔ common products found in all areas indicating some kind of trade ➔ did not use metal money but carried on all exchanges through barter ➔ cities like Mohenjo-

daro, Harappa, Lothal were important centres for metallurgy ➔ produced tools, weapons, kitchenware for wide distribution ➔ Rice seems to have been imported to Punjab from Gujarat ➔ Lothal and Surkotada provided cotton for expanding townships ➔ Balakot and Chanhudaro were centres for bangle-making ➔ Lothal and Chanhudaro were centres for manufacturing beads.

- External Trade: commercial contacts with western neighbours ➔ Lothal, Surkotada, Balakot were important trading coastal towns ➔ carried on trade with Mesopotamia and other West Asian sites ➔ set up trading colony in northern Afghanistan to facilitate trade with Central Asia ➔ Mesopotamian records from about 2300 BCE refer to trade relations with Meluha (ancient name for Indus region) ➔ texts refer to two intermediate trading stations called Dilmun and Makan ➔ Dilmun identified with Bahrain on Persian Gulf ➔ trade carried out by sea ➔ texts refer to Meluha as land of seafarers ➔ depictions of ships and boats on seals indicate this ➔ merchants exported and imported goods from West and Central Asian sites ➔ Gold imported from North Karnataka and Afghanistan ➔ copper from Rajasthan, South India, Baluchistan, Arabia ➔ lead from East or South India. 🏛️ 🚢

📍 **Topic: Weights, Measures, Transport, Art & Craft** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Category 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Weights	Made of stone; cubical in shape; basic unit was 16 (equal to 14 grams); larger multiples of 16, smaller fractions of 16.
Ekka	Modern horse cart that resembles the copper/bronze cart models found at Harappa and Chanhudaro.
Inanimate Objects	(Not alive) The most common terracotta models were bullock carts and ploughs.

Category 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Pottery	Crafted on potter's wheel; glossy/shining; decorated with black geometrical designs (large jars with narrow necks, red pots).

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Number of stone weights discovered ➔ used sets of cubical stone weights ➔ basic unit was 16 (equal to modern 14 grams) ➔ larger weights were multiples of 16 (32, 48, 64, 128) ➔ smaller ones were fractions of 16 ➔ Transport: several representations of ships found on seals at Harappa and Mohenjo-daro ➔ terracotta model of a ship discovered from Lothal ➔ boats carried goods from production centres to cities ➔ for inland travel, terracotta models of bullock carts provide evidence ➔ copper or bronze models of carts with seated drivers found from Harappa and Chanhudaro ➔ carts used resemble modern Ekka (horse cart).
    - Art and Craft: works of art (clay/terracotta figurines, stone/bronze sculpture, seals, beads) are products of skilled craftsmen ➔ piece of woven cotton discovered from Mohenjo-daro ➔ textile impressions found on several objects shows weaving was an important craft ➔ practised boat-making ➔ seal-making and terracotta articles were important crafts ➔ subjects portrayed on seals and terracotta figures include human beings, animals, birds ➔ human figurines shown wearing heavy ornaments, jewellery, elaborate headgear ➔ among inanimate (not alive) objects, most common were terracotta models of bullock carts and ploughs ➔ goldsmiths made jewellery of silver, gold, precious stones ➔ knew art of bead-making ➔ produced characteristic pottery (glossy and shining) ➔ earthen vessels crafted on potter's wheel ➔ decorated with black geometrical designs ➔ large jars with narrow necks and red pots with black decoration bear evidence of artistic skill ➔ Sculpture: artists were skilled sculptors ➔ portrayal of human and animal figures highly realistic with anatomical details ➔ statues

made in stone, bronze or terracotta ➔ large number of stone images found ➔ bust of a bearded man found in Mohenjo-daro is well known. ⚖️🏺

📍 **Topic: Terracotta, Bronze-Casting, Dress, Ornaments & Amusements** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Item / Process 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Mother Goddess	The most important terracotta image found in large numbers.
Lost Wax Process	Special technique for bronze casting: wax figure covered with clay ➔ wax melted by heating ➔ hollow mould filled with molten metal.
Potsherd	Broken piece of earthenware; one from Harappa depicts a man wearing a dhoti.
Amusements	Played dice, went hunting/fishing; musical instruments were the drum and lyre; toys included whistles, carts, bird figurines.

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Terracotta figurines found in large numbers ➔ most important is the Mother Goddess ➔ few figurines of bearded males with coiled hair standing rigidly upright ➔ male figurines of exactly same type found (might be of a deity) ➔ perhaps used as toys or cult figures ➔ large number of male and female figurines also found ➔ art of bronze-casting prevalent on wide scale ➔ bronze statues made using special lost wax process ➔ wax figures covered with clay coating ➔ wax melted by heating ➔ hollow mould filled with molten metal taking original shape ➔ bronze statue of dancing girl found at Mohenjo-daro is another masterpiece ➔ number of bronze

figures of animals (buffalo, rams) and models of carts unearthed ➔ Dress: men used to wear a dhoti (depicted on a potsherd/broken piece of earthenware from Harappa) ➔ wore a shawl as an upper garment (shown by priest figure from Mohenjo-daro) ➔ women wore a skirt and used a cloak to cover arms and shoulders ➔ discovery of needles and buttons show at least some clothes were stitched ➔ Ornaments: worn by both men and women ➔ common ornaments were necklaces, finger-rings, bangles, armlets, anklets, nose rings, fan-shaped head-dress, earrings ➔ made of gold, silver, precious stones, ivory ➔ Toys and Amusements: played games and had other forms of entertainment ➔ played dice and went on hunting and fishing expeditions ➔ main musical instruments were drum and lyre ➔ toys of birds, animals, figurines, carts, whistles were also made ➔ Harappan civilisation declined sometime around 1800 BCE. 👗🎲

📍 **Topic: Decline of the Civilisation & Heritage** 📌

- 🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table:**

Cause of Decline 🏷️	**Scholar / Key Detail** 📝
Floods & Earthquakes	R.L. Raikes (hydrologist); earthquakes raised flood plains, blocking Indus river to the sea, inundating Mohenjo-daro's hinterland.
Increased Aridity	D.P. Agarwal and Sood; river Ghaggar dried up due to tectonic shifts (Sutlej captured by Indus, Yamuna joined Ganges).
Deforestation	Enormous wood needed for bronze, jewellery, baking bricks/pottery, boats, furniture ➔ led to climatic change.

Cause of Decline 🏷️	Scholar / Key Detail 📝
Aryan Attack	Mortimer Wheeler; men, women, children massacred in streets (skeletons of 13 males/females, one child found in a room).

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Floods and Earthquakes: held by some scholars that floods in Mohenjo-daro led to abandonment of settlement ➔ inferred from fact that houses and streets were covered with silty clay left by flood waters ➔ submerged streets and houses ➔ people built up houses and streets on top of debris of previous buildings after floods receded ➔ time came when impoverished Harappans could not take it anymore and abandoned the settlement ➔ According to famous hydrologist R.L. Raikes, flooding could not be result of normal flooding in river Indus ➔ Earthquakes might have raised level of flood plains ➔ uplift of plain blocked passage of river to the sea ➔ rising water levels led to inundation of hinterland (internal area) of Mohenjo-daro ➔ Increased Aridity: According to renowned historians D.P. Agarwal and Sood, civilisation declined because of increasing aridity and drying up of river Ghaggar ➔ Sutlej and Yamuna used to be tributaries of river Ghaggar ➔ because of tectonic disturbances, Sutlej stream captured by Indus river ➔ Yamuna shifted east to join Ganges ➔ change left Ghaggar waterless ➔ ecological disturbance caused by increased aridity and shift in drainage pattern led to decline ➔ Deforestation: Since it was a Bronze Age culture, enormous quantities of wood needed to produce bronze ➔ wood also needed to produce jewellery, bake bricks, pottery, stoneware, make boats and furniture ➔ could have led to deforestation leading to climatic change in region ➔ Attack: Historians like Mortimer Wheeler believed Aryans destroyed Indus settlements ➔ in last phase of Mohenjo-daro, men, women, children massacred in streets and houses ➔ evident from skeletons of 13 males and females and one child found lying in a room.

- Heritage: decline of physical aspects did not lead to total disappearance of traits ➔ many features found in later cultural development ➔ way of making baked pottery, bricks, beads, jewellery, textiles adopted by later civilisations ➔ one of the most remarkable achievements was cultivation of cotton ➔ adopted by Egyptians after several centuries ➔ In religious sphere, worship of Pashupati Shiva, female deity as Mother Goddess, sacred trees, animals, serpents, religious symbols were prevalent and some continued to this day. 🌊🔥⚔️